

THE RIG VEDIC AGE (EARLY VEDIC)

RIG VEDA AS SOURCE → SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY → KIN POLITY: AUTHORITY WITHOUT → CATTLE-AGRICULTURE ECONOMY LOOP → SOCIETY: KINSHIP, DIFFERENCE AND → DEITIES, RITA, YAJNA AND

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g11 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 RIG VEDA AS SOURCE AND CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE

RIG VEDA AS SOURCE AND CHRONOLOGICAL SPINE FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION EARLIER CORE TRENDS VARIED/LATER MATERIAL DISCIPLINED TRANSMISSION WORKING EARLY VEDIC HORIZON BROADLY C. 1500-1000 BCE, NOT A DATE FOR EVERY

TEXT GIVES A POETIC-RITUAL WORLD; FREQUENCY AND SILENCE ARE

FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core

Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn.

Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core trends varied/later material disciplined transmission
- Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn.

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.
- FAMILY BOOKS (2-7) → OTHER LAYERS (1, 8, 9, 10) → REDACTION/ORAL PRESERVATION earlier core trends varied/later material disciplined transmission

IMPACT / LIMIT

- Working early Vedic horizon: broadly c. 1500-1000 BCE, not a date for every hymn.
- Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Text gives a poetic-ritual world; frequency and silence are not census data.

01

STAGE 01 SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY

SAPTA-SINDHU TEXTUAL GEOGRAPHY NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU KABUL/KUBHA ---- INDUS/SINDHU ---- PUNJAB RIVERS ---- SARASVATI/DRISHADVATI ZONE RIVERS ORGANISE PRAISE, MOVEMENT, PASTURE AND CONFLICT; GEOGRAPHY IS GANGA IS MARGINAL IN THIS HORIZON; LATER VEDIC EXPANSION

DO NOT TURN REMEMBERED RIVERS INTO PRECISE POLITICAL BORDERS.

NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU

Kabul/Kubha ---- Indus/Sindhu ---- Punjab rivers ---- Sarasvati/Drishadvati zone mountain routes trunk river pastoral/farming eastern

Rivers organise praise, movement, pasture and conflict; geography is selective.

Ganga is marginal in this horizon; later Vedic expansion shifts the centre east.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU
- Kabul/Kubha ---- Indus/Sindhu ---- Punjab rivers ---- Sarasvati/Drishadvati zone mountain routes trunk river pastoral/farming eastern attention

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Rivers organise praise, movement, pasture and conflict; geography is selective.
- Ganga is marginal in this horizon; later Vedic expansion shifts the centre east.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.
- NORTH-WESTERN MILIEU

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Do not turn remembered rivers into precise political borders.

02

STAGE 02 KIN POLITY: AUTHORITY WITHOUT TERRITORIAL STATE

KIN POLITY AUTHORITY WITHOUT TERRITORIAL STATE WAR LEADERSHIP, PROTECTION, DISTRIBUTION AND RITUAL STATUS; NOT ABSOLUTE SMALLER/SELECT ASSEMBLY CONTEXT BROADER ASSEMBLY PUROHITA MARTIAL ROLE GROUP LEADER

OFFERING/TRIBUTE, NOT A REGULAR LAND-REVENUE BUREAUCRACY

KULA → GRAMA → VIS → JANA

RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch sabha: smaller/select assembly context

samiti: broader assembly purohita: adviser

senani: martial role

gramani: group leader

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- KULA → GRAMA → VIS → JANA
- RAJAN: war leadership, protection, distribution and ritual status; not absolute monarch sabha: smaller/select assembly context
- samiti: broader assembly purohita: adviser

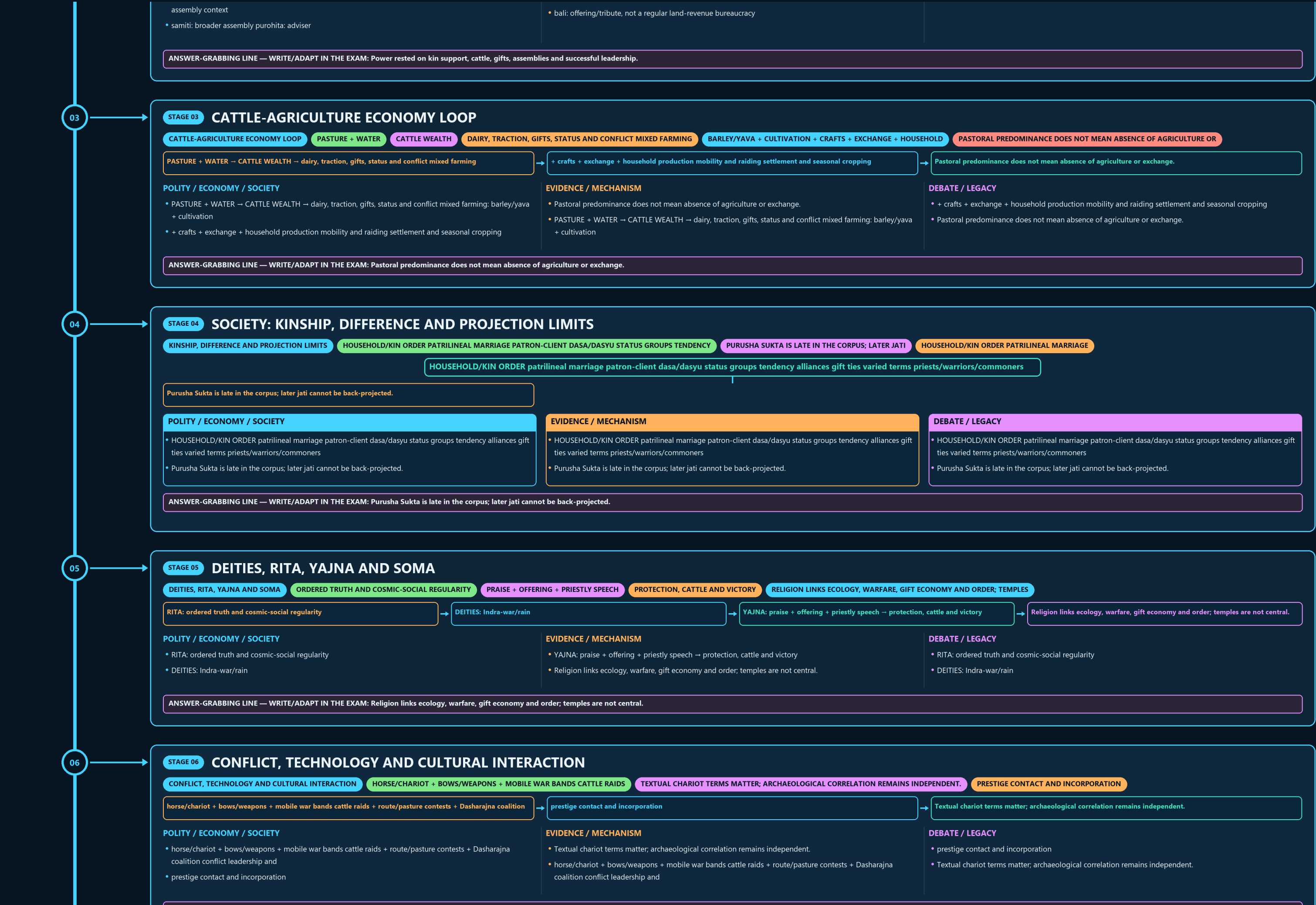
EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- senani: martial role
- gramani: group leader
- bali: offering/tribute, not a regular land-revenue bureaucracy

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Power rested on kin support, cattle, gifts, assemblies and successful leadership.



horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture contests + Dasharajna coalition

prestige contact and incorporation

Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and
- prestige contact and incorporation

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.
- horse/chariot + bows/weapons + mobile war bands cattle raids + route/pasture contests + Dasharajna coalition conflict leadership and

DEBATE / LEGACY

- prestige contact and incorporation
- Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Textual chariot terms matter; archaeological correlation remains independent.

07

STAGE 07

EARLY TO LATER VEDIC TRANSFORMATION

EARLY TO LATER VEDIC TRANSFORMATION

EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC NORTH-WEST/SAPTA-SINDHU UPPER GANGA-YAMUNA AND EASTWARD

CUMULATIVE TRANSFORMATION WITH REGIONAL VARIATION, NOT ABRUPT RUPTURE.

RATNINS CATTLE-CENTRED MIXED ECONOMY PLOUGH AGRICULTURE, SURPLUS AND CRAFTS

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership janapada, stronger monarchy and	yajna royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning	EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership janapada, stronger monarchy and
ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and	VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.	ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership janapada, stronger monarchy and
- ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- yajna royal ritual and Upanishadic questioning
- VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- EARLY VEDIC LATER VEDIC north-west/Sapta-Sindhu upper Ganga-Yamuna and eastward movement jana and kin leadership janapada, stronger monarchy and
- ratnins cattle-centred mixed economy plough agriculture, surplus and crafts fluid differentiation firmer varna/patriarchy and gotra deity praise and

MECHANISM / VERDICT — VERDICT: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: cumulative transformation with regional variation, not abrupt rupture.

08

STAGE 08

RIG VEDIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

RIG VEDIC ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

10 MARKS

SOURCE CAUTION

HYMN TERM

15 MARKS

ARCHAEOLOGY CAUTION

20 MARKS

KIN SYSTEM

10 MARKS: source caution — institution/economy — hymn term — qualification

15 MARKS: geography — polity — economy — society — religion — archaeology caution

20 MARKS: corpus/layers — Sapta-Sindhu — kin system — cattle-agriculture loop

differentiation — ritual worldview — conflict/contact — transition

AVOID: nomad-only, caste-complete, state/empire or homogeneous-date claims.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 10 MARKS: source caution — institution/economy — hymn term — qualification
- 15 MARKS: geography — polity — economy — society — religion — archaeology caution

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 20 MARKS: corpus/layers — Sapta-Sindhu — kin system — cattle-agriculture loop
- differentiation — ritual worldview — conflict/contact — transition

DEBATE / LEGACY

- AVOID: nomad-only, caste-complete, state/empire or homogeneous-date claims.
- CLOSE: a layered pastoral-agricultural kin society undergoing differentiation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: source caution — institution/economy — hymn term — qualification.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ORIENTATION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A1. TEXTUAL STRATIFICATION AND ORAL-FORMULAIC METHOD — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A2. GIFT ECONOMY AND REDISTRIBUTION — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A3. INDO-IRANIAN RELIGIOUS COMPARISON — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A4. DASA/DASYU, VARNA AND BOUNDARY-MAKING — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

A5. HOUSEHOLD, GENDER, FUNERAL AND PHILOSOPHICAL MATERIAL — [OPTIONAL]

A6. ARCHAEOLOGY, HORSE AND CHARIOT LIMITS — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- Optional Advanced Orientation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A1. Textual Stratification and Oral-Formulaic Method — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A2. Gift Economy and Redistribution — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A3. Indo-Iranian Religious Comparison — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

ADVANCED DEBATE

- A4. Dasa/Dasyu, Varna and Boundary-Making — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A5. Household, Gender, Funeral and Philosophical Material — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A6. Archaeology, Horse and Chariot Limits — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- A7. Historical Memory and Historiography — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]

LEGACY / NUANCE

- Advanced Evidence Clinics: Applying the Limits — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED]
- Optional Advanced Orientation — [OPTIONAL ADVANCED] The following material enriches the core session but is not required for
- a competent Prelims or Mains answer.
- Oral stability can preserve archaic language, while composition and transmission still create layers.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.